# Brightside Family Dental - Instrument Sterilization SOP

Infection control procedure

Standard operating procedure for instrument processing. Sample text for demonstration only; follow the manufacturer's instructions and current CDC guidance in a real practice.

## Handpieces

After each patient: run the handpiece for 20 seconds to flush water lines, wipe it down, clean and lubricate it as the manufacturer directs, bag it, and sterilize it in the autoclave. Handpieces are never only wiped and reused.

## Autoclave

Standard cycle: 132 degrees Celsius (270 F) for 4 minutes, followed by the drying cycle. Every pouch carries a chemical indicator, and each load is logged with the date, cycle number and operator's initials.

## Spore testing

A biological spore test is run on the autoclave every week, on Monday's first load, and after any repair. A failed test means the autoclave is taken out of use and the office manager is told the same day.

## Sharps

Sharps go into the red sharps container in each operatory. Containers are closed and replaced when three-quarters full.